

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Ms Nafisa Amini

Address: 196 Buckland Way Worcester Park KT4 8NP

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: We respectfully submit this statement in support of the proposed mosque, addressing the key concerns raised and demonstrating that the development will not result in severe or unacceptable impacts.

1. Highway Impact

The peak activity associated with Friday prayers is short in duration, predictable, and occurs once weekly - it is not continuous or daily traffic generation. Importantly:

- There is no overlap with the 8:30am school peak.
- Afternoon school collection times are staggered due to after-school clubs and childcare, reducing concentrated congestion.
- Friday congregations have been responsibly staggered since 2021, significantly dispersing arrival and departure times.
- The site has already been operating in real-world conditions for several years without causing severe highway harm.

The transport impact does not meet the threshold of being "severe," particularly given its limited frequency and duration.

2. Parking and Overspill

Concerns regarding parking overspill are overstated:

- A significant proportion of attendees live locally and walk to the mosque.
- The proposed on-site parking and improved layout represent an enhancement compared to the current arrangement.

- Any overspill is short-term, not constant, daily, or continuous.
- Prayer attendance involves brief stays, resulting in quick turnover rather than long-term parking occupation.

This pattern of use is materially different from high-intensity commercial or all-day venues.

3. Cul-de-Sac and Local Road Network

While the surrounding road network is constrained, activity related to worship is:

- Brief and staggered rather than sustained.
- Comparable to existing weekly use that has operated without demonstrable harm.
- Limited to once-weekly peak activity rather than functioning as a daily high-traffic generator.

Most attendees are local residents who access the mosque on foot, further reducing vehicular pressure.

4. Late Evening Amenity and Noise

Amenity concerns are limited in scope:

- Worship activities take place predominantly indoors.
- Dispersal is calm, orderly, and short in duration.
- There are no consistent competing peak evening events from nearby venues that would compound impact.

There is no evidence that the mosque would cause significant or ongoing disturbance to neighbouring residents.

5. Cumulative Impact

The suggestion of cumulative impact with other local venues does not reflect operational reality:

- Peak activity times do not consistently coincide.
- Friday prayer times vary throughout the year.
- The limited duration of worship significantly reduces any potential overlap effects.

Any cumulative effect would therefore be occasional and brief, not sustained.

6. Demonstrable Local Need

There is a clear and established local need for this facility:

- The mosque provides essential women's services and wider community support.
- Current temporary arrangements are insufficient to meet demand.
- The development primarily serves existing local users - it is not expected to generate a new influx of visitors from outside the area.

This proposal formalises and improves an already functioning community service.

Conclusion

The evidence demonstrates that the proposed mosque:

- Does not generate continuous or severe highway impacts.
- Improves parking arrangements compared to the current situation.
- Operates on a limited, predictable, and well-managed weekly peak.
- Meets a genuine and growing local community need.

On balance, the social, community, and equality benefits clearly outweigh the limited and short-duration impacts identified.

We respectfully ask the Council to support this important community development.